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RedDeezyD

New to Pixel

Heya,

Just switched from my old Samsung galaxy to Google Pixel 10. What features should I be taking advantage or now / best settings to get the most out of the Pixel.

Thanks!



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Circle to search is the best one



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[Reply](#)**Procontroller40** • 17d ago **Top 1% Commenter**

Samsung devices have had circle to search since the beginning.

[Reply](#)**pmc64** • 17d ago

I've had my 9a for 2 months and just tried it. That's pretty useful.

**Chipmunk_III** • 17d ago

Magsafe/Pixel snap accessories and now playing,

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Go through your apps and determine which ones don't need "run processes in the background" and "use data in the background". Two different settings under the app settings menu. You can get there via "apps" in settings too. Unfortunately you will find some non-essential apps Google has greyed out that option for, but I have the same functionality after disabling 90+% of those switches.

My phone battery seems to last significantly longer maybe over 50% longer and the phone is much more responsive and never gets warm.

I also set the animation scale in developer settings to 0.5x because I find most normal speed animations testing my patience lol.

Looong edit: Also I ended up disabling about 15 background apps that came with my Pixel 9a. All the stuff like AI Core, Emoji Workshop Wallpaper, AI Wallpaper, Android System Intelligence, Pixel VIPs, Private Compute Services, Speech Recognition and Synthesis from Google (speech still works for me), Voice Access, Pixel Studio, Pixel Troubleshooting, Pixel Stand, Pixel Buds, My Pixel, Google Play Services for AR, Files By Google (you might need this one, they have since removed the shortcut to the actual vanilla Android file explorer so I had to make an app in Android Studio that's basically a shortcut to it), Dreams, DiagnosticsTool, Device Policy, Device Health Services, Device Connectivity Service, and some others.

Phew. Long list more me. But I still have Bluetooth audio, wireless charging, sync with my PC, and pretty much everything you would assume would stop working still works. I wish they gave us a little more control because the actual vanilla Android file explorer is installed and functional on all of our phones, but Google hides that in favor of theirs which is pretty much the same but with built in Drive and other cloud services that scan your storage. It seems a little unnecessary to not allow us to uninstall some apps like Chrome (even though Android already has webview ready as a fallback), Gboard which by default collects a ton of your data, Digital Wellbeing which necessitates knowing your usage activity and you can't even disable it, and many more...

Still love my Pixel though! Imo with the pros and cons it averages out to much better than most other phones for me. It's my favorite phone I've owned and I hope you enjoy yours :)



YaBoiiSpoderman • 17d ago

You shouldn't tell a new user to disable a ton of shit...

3 weeks later when OP is wondering why things don't work correctly he's not gonna remember what he disabled, why he disabled it

OP I would not listen to this guy, disabling all these things that run in your pixel by default is NOT a good idea

And if you feel the need to disable 40% of pixel default services why do you even own a Pixel? Just get an iPhone?



RedDeezyD OP • 17d ago

Appreciate the in depth reply!



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wallpapers...but disabling is still better than nothing. Though, I didn't disable nearly as many as you did.



seven-cents • 17d ago • Edited 17d ago

Your phone should have an App called My Pixel installed that you can try using. It's supposed to give lots of useful advice and tips.

Give it a go.. personally I disabled it because it was consuming massive amounts of data in the background (AI crap phoning home to Google). It might have improved by now.

p.s. I recommend disabling it from the system settings after you've explored what it has to offer. It's a spam engine



RedDeezyD OP • 17d ago

Cheers!



DBear1985 • 17d ago

If you use your phone for you know, phone calls. Your world will be rocked by the handy AI stuff



Procontroller40 • 17d ago

Top 1% Commenter

Tinker with your call screening settings. I have missed a lot of important calls that my phone marked as spam so it even never rang before adjusting the settings.